

current situation, is NOT to let things get worse and instead to get away from the growing cloud of financial insecurity you're so used to living under. You aren't really living within your means until you've saved three months' salary as a protective cushion, and that's on top of all other nonliquid assets. You may not see now that you're inches away from disaster, but I'm telling you the truth about what your 90-Day Number is revealing: You're just one major illness, one job loss, or one big market correction away from penury, or from losing your house, or worse. Time to make some changes. I'll help you do that.

Now, if you've done the math and your 90-Day Number is in the heavy negatives, then, like a majority of men and women out there, you simply spend more than you make. You're constantly operating in the red. It feels like you're living only to finance your debts or pay your bills. You are in constant fear of losing your job, or of your assets losing their value. You worry that one big, unexpected bill might put you under for good, and then you avoid that thought. You're avoiding the phone and people to whom you owe money. Maybe you're retreating from friends and family out of fear or shame. You're steeped in magical thinking about money—for example, believing you're one lottery ticket, inheritance, or windfall away from total financial transformation. You wake up in despair and you go to bed defeated. You don't live within your means because you don't even know what they are. You're *not* one illness, one job loss, one market correction, or one false move away from complete financial disaster. *Disaster is already here.*

If this is you, you must admit it to yourself now and take every necessary step to correct it. Our understanding of money is formed early. But I believe people raised in poverty or with parents who severely mismanaged money can be at an advantage here. They know much more clearly what *not* to do with money; they know what kind of relationship they *don't* want with money. They've tasted that fear. Like me, they've seen fear etched on their parents' faces. People who've experienced poverty often have a greater drive and a stronger commitment to change. I know people like this. I admire them.

On the other hand, those raised in relative ease and comfort often have the hardest time changing their relationship to money.